The Mark of the Beast

Purpose: *To identify the Beast and its Mark.*

Centred on*: Jesus alone is worthy of our Worship and Allegiance, for he is our God, Creator and Redeemer.*

Revelation 14:6-12…a solemn warning not to worship the beast or to receive the mark of the beast is given by a God who loves us more than life itself as part of the everlasting gospel of the 3 angels message. (Heb 8:10…New covenant)

2 Peter 3:9… God warns us about the mark of the beast because He loves everyone and does not want anyone to be deceived or lost.

Daniel 7:17, 23… a beast in Bible prophecy represents an earthly kingdom or power.

Revelation 13:2… the sea beast in Revelation 13 receives power and authority from the dragon.

Revelation 13:11…The land beast in Revelation 13 speaks like a dragon.

Revelation 12:17… Both of these beasts are connected with the dragon who makes war with those who keep God's commandments which includes worshipping God on the Bible Sabbath (Saturday).

Revelation 13: 4, 8, 12, 15… the central issue of the mark of the beast is worship therefore there must be a difference between the call to the worship the beast and the one to worship God.

Exodus 20:8-11… In contrast to the worship of the beast God's moral law directs us to the seventh-day Sabbath as the time we are to worship God, and is quoted from in the message of the 3rd angel.

Daniel 7:25… Saturday is the Lord's day of worship but prophecy predicts that the little horn of Daniel would seek to change times and laws (this is why most people today believe that Sunday is the Bible Sabbath and not Saturday). Here is where Satan is seeking to deceive the world concerning worship.

Revelation 13:15-17… no one will receive the mark of the beast until legislation is passed enforcing Sunday laws with the power to enforce them by economic boycott and death. (Ephesians 1:13; 4:30….Sealed by God)

Ecclesiastes 9:10… the hand symbolizes what we do, our actions, but not necessarily what we believe (many will go along with laws enforcing Sunday sacredness due to economic pressure even though they do not believe Sunday is the day of worship i.e. Muslim nations like Pakistan; Secular states like Oregon).

Revelation 4:11 … God is the only One worthy of our worship because He only is the Creator, and Redeemer. God is the source of life for all people and the only hope of eternal life for those who would trust in Him.

Appeal

The Bible places an important emphasis upon our understanding and worship of God. When we know God, we will choose to serve Him and worship Him according to His Word, because it is His Word and that Word alone that gives us life. Jesus is the Word. He is our salvation, our wisdom and righteousness. To worship Him is the only option for those who see this wonderful truth of the gospel. When should we do it? On what day? Whatever day He commands, whatever day He wishes, whatever day He, in His Word, calls us to remember to worship Him on. The power to worship Him is in His Word. In the final analysis, we can only keep holy that day which God Himself has made holy. To remember the Sabbath is to remember that we are powerless to save and powerless to make holy. To remember that fact is to remember the everlasting gospel that produces a people who worship the Creator/Redeemer who make heaven and earth and the fountains of water.

Defend it

The Converts Catechism — "Question—Have you any other way of proving that the church (Roman Catholic) has power to institute festivals of precept?
"Answer—Had she not such power, she could not have done that in which all modern religionists agree with her–she could not have substituted the observance of Sunday, the first day of the week, for the observance of Saturday, the seventh day, a change for which there is not scriptural authority." *(A Doctrinal Catechism*, by Stephen Deenan, p. 174).
"Question—Which is the Sabbath day?
"Answer—Saturday is the Sabbath day.
"Question—Why do we observe Sunday instead of Saturday?
"Answer—We observe Sunday instead of Saturday because the Catholic Church, in the Council of Laodicea (A.D. 364), transferred the solemnity from Saturday to Sunday" (Peter Geiermann, *The Convert's Catechism of Catholic Doctrine*, p. 50, 1977).

Mark of the beast — As a beast in prophecy represents any earthly kingdom or power, the mark of the beast would constitute the distinguishing feature of such a power. What is the distinguishing mark of the papal power? Could it be the substitution of Sunday observance in the place of God's seventh-day Sabbath?

Rome says: "Of course the Catholic Church claims that the change was her act. And the act is a *mark* of her ecclesiastical power and authority in religious matters*" (The Faith of Our Fathers*, Cardinal Gibbons, p. 14).

Again, Rome says of the change of worship from the seventh-day Sabbath to Sunday, "It's the *mark* of our authority to overrule God's law" (Father Enright C.S.S.R. of the Redemptoral College, Kansas City, Mo., *History of the Sabbath*, p. 802).

666—Man's Number

"Here is wisdom. Let him that hath understanding count the number of the beast: for it is the number of a man; and his number is six hundred threescore and six" (Revelation 13:18).

We are told to count or calculate this number. Six hundred and sixty-six is the calculated total sum of the Roman numerical value of the title, "Vicarius Filii Dei," an official title of the Pope, the man at the head of this power. (V=5; I=1; C=100; A=0; R=0; I=1; U=5; S=0; F=0; I=1; L=50; I=1; I=1; D=500; E=0; I=1).*

This makes sense, since the power brought to view here is the papal power. Yet there is another meaning to 666.

Six is the number of man. Mankind were created on the sixth day. God's number is seven, which represents perfection and completeness (see Genesis 2:1-3). Six falls short of seven as the papal system falls short of the gospel. The religious system of Rome is represented by three sixes because it is man's counterfeit to the completed and perfect work of God. Instead of pointing us to the three powers of heaven, God the Father, Son and Holy Spirit, we are directed to the beast, the dragon and the false prophet (see Revelation 16:13). The bottom line is:

6 = Man's authority (see Acts 5:29).

6 = Man's traditions (see Matthew 15: 3).

6 = Man's commandments (see Mark 7:7).

Calendar — Shows7th day is Saturday

Dictionary — Defines 7th day of the week as Saturday and 1st Day of the week as Sunday.

Appendix: The Mark of the Beast

Sabbath, Change of, Catholic Authority Claimed for:

The Divine institution of a day of rest from ordinary occupations and of religious worship, transferred by the authority of the Church from the Sabbath, the last day, to Sunday, the first day of the week, … is one of the most patent signs that we are a Christian people.

Source: James Cardinal Gibbons, "The Claims of the Catholic Church in the Making of the Republic," in John Gilmary Shea and others, The Cross and the Flag, Our Church and Country (New York: The Catholic Historical League of America, 1899), pp. 24, 25. [FRS No. 104.]

Sabbath: Altered by man! (Catholic Testimony on the Change):

"Of course the Catholic Church claims that the change (Saturday Sabbath to Sunday) was her act... And the act is a ***MARK*** of her ecclesiastical authority in religious things.

Source: H.F. Thomas, Chancellor of Cardinal Gibbons. Nov. 11, 1895

"Sunday is our ***MARK*** of authority . . . the church is above the Bible, and this transference of Sabbath observance is proof of that fact.

Source: "Catholic Record of London, Ontario" Sept 1, 1923.

"The Pope has the power to change times, to abrogate laws, and to dispense with all things, even the precepts of Christ." "The Pope has the authority and often exercised it, to dispense with the command of Christ."

Source: Decretal, de Tranlatic Episcop. Cap. (The Pope can modify divine law.) Ferraris' Ecclesiastical Dictionary.

"The Sunday...is purely a creation of the Catholic Church."

Source: American Catholic Quarterly Review, January 1883

"Sunday...It is the law of the Catholic Church alone..."

Source: American Sentinel (Catholic) June 1893

"The Catholic church," declared Cardinal Gibbons, "by virtue of her divine mission changed the day from Saturday to Sunday."

Source: Catholic Mirror Sept. 23 1983. (Official organ of Cardinal Gibbons)

"The Pope is of great authority and power that he can modify, explain, or interpret even divine laws... The Pope can ***MODIFY*** divine law, since ***his power is not of man, But of God***, and he acts as vicegerent of God upon earth."

Source: Lucius Ferraris, Prompta Ribliotheca, "Papa," art. 2, translated.

"The authority of the church could therefore not be bound to the authority of the Scriptures, because the Church had changed the Sabbath into Sunday, not by command of Christ, but by its own authority."

Source: Canon and Tradition, p. 263

"Is not every Christian obliged to sanctify Sunday and to abstain on that day from unnecessary servile work? Is not the observance of this law among the most prominent of our sacred duties? But you may read the Bible from Genesis to Revelation, and you will not find a single line authorizing the sanctification of Sunday. The Scriptures enforce the religious observance of Saturday, a day which we never sanctify."

Source: James Cardinal Gibbons, The Faith of Our Fathers (1917 ed.), pp. 72, 73.

"The Catholic church," declared Cardinal Gibbons, "by virtue of her divine mission changed the day from Saturday to Sunday."

Source: Catholic Mirror Sept. 23 1983. (Official organ of Cardinal Gibbons)

Question - Which is the Sabbath day?

Answer - Saturday is the Sabbath day.

Question - Why do we observe Sunday instead of Saturday?

Answer - We observe Sunday instead of Saturday because the Catholic Church, in the Council of Laodicea (A.D. 364), transferred the solemnity from Saturday to Sunday."

Source: The Convert's Catechism of Catholic Doctrine, p. 50, 3rd ed.

"The Bible says, Remember that thou keep holy the Sabbath day. The Catholic church says, No! By my divine power I abolish the Sabbath day, and command you to keep the first day of the week. And lo, the entire civilized world bows down in reverent obedience to the command of the holy Catholic church!"

Source: Father Enright, C.S.S.R. of the Redemptoral College, Kansas City, History of the Sabbath, p. 802

"Perhaps the boldest thing, the most revolutionary change the Church ever did, happened in the first century. The holy day, the Sabbath, was changed from Saturday to Sunday. "The day of the Lord" was chosen, not from any direction noted in the Scriptures, but from the Church's sense of its own power.... People who think that the Scriptures should be the sole authority, should logically become Seventh-day Adventists, and keep Saturday holy."

Source: Saint Catherine Church Sentinel*, Algonac, Michigan, May 21, 1995.*

"Sunday is a Catholic institution and its claim to observance can be defended only on Catholic principles .... From beginning to end of Scripture there is not a single passage that warrants the transfer of weekly public worship from the last day of the week to the first."

Source: Catholic Press*, Sydney, Australia, August, 1990.*

"The Adventists are the only body of Christians with the Bible as their teacher, who could find no warrant in its pages for the change of day from the seventh to the first. Hence their appellation," Seventh-day Adventists. "They're cardinal principle consists in setting apart Saturday for the exclusive worship of God, in conformity with the positive command of God Himself, repeatedly reiterated in the sacred books of the Old and New testaments, literally kept by the children of Israel for thousands of years to this day, and endorsed by the teaching and practice of the Son of God while on earth."

"Is not yet too late for Protestants to redeem themselves. Will they do it? Will they indeed take the written word only, the Scripture alone, as their sole authority and their sole standard? Or will they still hold the indefensible, self-contradictory and suicidal doctrine and practice of following the authority of the Catholic Church and wear the SIGN of her authority? Will they keep the Sabbath of the Lord, the seventh day, according to Scripture? Or will they keep the Sunday according to the tradition of the Catholic Church."

Source: Rome's Challenge, (Why do Protestants keep Sunday?)

Sabbath, Change of, Catholic Substitution without Scriptural Authority:

Question: Have you any other way of proving that the Church has power to institute festivals of precept?

Answer: Had she not such power, she could not have done that in which all modern religionists agree with her;—she could not have substituted the observance of Sunday the first day of the week, for the observance of Saturday the seventh day, a change for which there is no Scriptural authority.

Source: Stephen Keenan, A Doctrinal Catechism (3d American ed., rev.; New York: T. W. Strong, late Edward Dunigan & Bro., 1876), p. 174. [FRS No. 7.]

Tradition, Protestants Accused of Following:

Because the origin of our faith is not the Bible alone, but rather the Church, which gives us both the written and the unwritten word…So in the New Law, Catholics believe some things not in the Scriptures, although wholly in accord with them, because of the infallible witness of the Church as to their divine or apostolic origin. Why do Protestants accept the Scriptures as inspired? Why do they honour the first day of the week instead of the seventh? Why do they baptize children? Contrary to their principles, they must look outside the Bible to the voice of tradition, which is not human, but divine, because guaranteed by the divine, infallible witness of the Catholic Church.

Source: Bertrand L. Conway, The Question-Box Answers (New York: The Columbus Press, 1910), pp. 75, 76. Issued earlier by "The Missionary Society of St. Paul the Apostle in the State of New York." [FRS No. 6.]

Sunday, Protestants Taunted for Observance of—Only Seventh-day Adventists Consistent:

Question: By what authority did the Church change the observance of the Sabbath from Saturday to Sunday?

Answer: The Church changed the observance of the Sabbath to Sunday by right of the divine, infallible authority given to her by her Founder, Jesus Christ. The Protestant, claiming the Bible to be the only guide of faith, has no warrant for observing Sunday. In this matter the Seventh Day Adventist is the only consistent Protestant. Sunday as the day of rest to honour our Lord's Resurrection dates to apostolic times and was so established among other reasons, to mark off the Jew from the Christian. St. Justin the Martyr speaks of it in his Apologies.

Source: "The Question Box," The Catholic Universe Bulletin, 69 (Aug. 14, 1942), 4. [FRS No. 51.]

Sunday—Protestants Taunted with Seventh-day Adventists' Example:

Question: (a) The Bible says "The seventh day is the Sabbath of the Lord," and we read in your literature that it is the only Bible Sabbath there is. Will you please explain how the Sunday observance originated? (b) Do you think the Seventh Day Adventists keep the right day?

Answer: (a) If you follow the Bible alone there can be no question that you are obliged to keep Saturday holy, since that is the day especially prescribed by Almighty God to be kept holy to the Lord. In keeping Sunday, non-Catholics are simply following the practise of the Catholic Church for 1800 years, a tradition, and not a Bible ordinance. What we would like to know is: Since they deny the authority of the Church, on what grounds can they base their faith of keeping Sunday. Those who keep Saturday, like the Seventh Day Adventists, unquestionably have them by the hip in this practice. And they cannot give them any sufficient answer which would satisfy an unprejudiced mind. With the Catholics there is no difficulty about the matter. For, since we deny that the Bible is the sole rule of faith, we can fall back upon the constant practise and tradition of the Church which, long before the reign of Constantine, even in the very days of the apostles themselves, were accustomed to keep the first day of the week instead of the last.

Source: F. G. Lentz, The Question Box (New York: Christian Press Association, 1900), pp. 98, 99. [FRS No. 54.]

Sabbath, Change of, Not in Scriptures:

For, when there could not be produced one solitary place in the Holy Scriptures which testified that either the Lord Himself or the apostles had ordered such a transfer of the Sabbath to Sunday, then it was not easy to answer the question: Who has transferred the Sabbath, and who has had the right to do it?

Source: George Sverdrup, "En ny Dag" *("A New Day"), in "Sondagen og dens Helligholdelse" ("Sunday and Its Observance"), reprinted from Kvartal–Skrift ("Quarterly Journal"), 4 (1878), 5 (1879), in his Samlede Skrifter ("Collected Works"), ed. by Andreas Helland, Vol. 1 (Minneapolis: Frikirkens Boghandels Forlag, 1909), p. 342. Norwegian. Used by permission of Messenger Printing, Inc., Minneapolis, Minn.*

Sabbath, Change of—Catholics Claim Sunday as Protestant Homage to Papal Authority:

It was the Catholic Church which, by the authority of Jesus Christ, has transferred this rest to the Sunday in remembrance of the resurrection of our Lord. Thus the observance of Sunday by the Protestants is an homage they pay, in spite of themselves, to the authority of the [Catholic] Church.

Source: Louis Gaston de Ségur, Plain Talk about the Protestantism of To-day (Boston: Patrick Donahoe, 1868), p. 225.

Comments of unity from Churches and other Authorities about the Sabbath:

Catholic: "You may read the Bible from Genesis to Revelation, and you will not find a single line authorizing the sanctification of Sunday. The Scriptures enforce the religious observance of Saturday, a day which we [Catholics] never sanctify."

James Cardinal Gibbons, The Faith of Our Fathers, 16th edition, 1880, p. 111.

Baptist: "There was and is a commandment to keep holy the Sabbath day, but that Sabbath day was not Sunday. ... It will be said, however, and with some show of triumph, that the Sabbath was transferred from the seventh to the first day of the week. ... Where can the record of such a transaction be found? Not in the New Testament--absolutely not. There is no scriptural evidence of the change of the Sabbath institution from the seventh to the first day of the week."

Dr. Edward T. Hiscox, author of The Baptist Manual, in a paper read before a New York ministers' conference held Nov. 13, 1893.

Church of Christ: "Finally, we have the testimony of Christ on this subject. In Mark 2:27, he says: 'The Sabbath was made for man, and not man for the Sabbath.' From this passage it is evident that the Sabbath was made not merely for the *Israelites*, as Paley and Hengstenberg would have us believe, but for *man* ... that is, for *the race*. Hence we conclude that the Sabbath was sanctified from the beginning, and that it was given to Adam, even in Eden, as one of those primeval institutions that God ordained for the happiness of all men."

Robert Milligan, Scheme of Redemption, (St. Louis, The Bethany Press, 1962), p. 165.

Congregationalist: "The Christian Sabbath [Sunday] is not in the Scriptures, and was not by the primitive church called the Sabbath."

Dwight's Theology, Vol. 4, p. 401.

Episcopal: "Sunday (*Dies Solis*, of the Roman calendar, 'day of the sun', because dedicated to the sun), the first day of the week, was adopted by the early Christians as a day of worship. ... No regulations for its observance are laid down in the New Testament, nor, indeed, is its observance even enjoined."

"Sunday," A Religious Encyclopedia, Vol. 3, (New York, Funk and Wagnalls, 1883) p. 2259.

Lutheran: "The observance of the Lord's day [Sunday] is founded not on any command of God, but on the authority of the church."

Augsburg Confession of Faith, quoted in Catholic Sabbath Manual, Part 2, Chapter 1, Section 10.

Methodist: "Take the matter of Sunday. There are indications in the New Testament as to how the church came to keep the first day of the week as its day of worship, but there is no passage telling Christians to keep that day, or to transfer the Jewish Sabbath to that day."

Harris Franklin Rall, Christian Advocate, July 2, 1942.

Moody Bible Institute: "The Sabbath was binding in Eden, and it has been in force ever since. This fourth commandment begins with the word 'remember,' showing that the Sabbath already existed when God wrote the law on the tables of stone at Sinai. How can men claim that this one commandment has been done away with when they will admit that the other nine are still binding?"

D. L. Moody, Weighed and Wanting, p. 47.

Presbyterian: "Until, therefore, it can be shown that the whole moral law has been repealed, the Sabbath will stand. ... The teaching of Christ confirms the perpetuity of the Sabbath."

T. C. Blake, D.D., Theology Condensed, pp. 474, 475.

Pentecostal: "'Why do we worship on Sunday? Doesn't the Bible teach us that Saturday should be the Lord's Day?' ... Apparently we will have to seek the answer from some other source than the New Testament." --David A. Womack, "Is Sunday the Lord's Day?"

The Pentecostal Evangel, Aug. 9, 1959, No. 2361, p. 3.

Encyclopedia: "Sunday was a name given by the heathen to the first day of the week, because it was the day on which they worshiped the sun, ... the seventh day was blessed and hallowed by God Himself, and ... He requires His creatures to keep it holy to Him. This commandment is of universal and perpetual obligation."

Eadie's Biblical Cyclopedia, 1872 ed., p. 561.

Baptist: "There was and is a commandment to keep holy the Sabbath day, but that Sabbath day was not Sunday. ... It will be said, however, and with some show of triumph, that the Sabbath was transferred from the seventh to the first day of the week. ... Where can the record of such a transaction be found? Not in the New Testament--absolutely not. There is no scriptural evidence of the change of the Sabbath institution from the seventh to the first day of the week."

Dr. Edward T. Hiscox, author of The Baptist Manual, in a paper read before a New York ministers' conference held Nov. 13, 1893.

Does the following show any comparison to Revelation 13?

Vatican pushes for Sunday Laws:

Sunday "is the identity of the Christian community and the centre of his life and mission", that "we cannot live without joining together on Sunday", that only those Christians "who lived in accordance with Sunday" have "attained new hope", and that "the Christians of today will rediscover the crucial importance of the Sunday Celebration".

Pastoral Visit of Pope Benedict XVI to Bari for the Closing of the 24th Italian National Eucharistic Congress, Homily of Pope Benedict XVI, Esplanade of Marisabella, Sunday, May 29, 2005.

Saturday is "no longer" the worship day of God, only on Sunday can we become part of the body of Christ in the world, and only by worshiping on Sunday can we avoid "egoistic isolation" and instead be united "in a great community...a universal community"becoming"related to everyone in the world.

Meeting with Diocesan Clergy of Aosta, Address of Pope Benedict XVI, Parish Church at Introd (Aosta Valley), Monday, July 25, 2005.

Every Sunday is to be dedicated and given to God.

Mass on the Solemnity of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary, Homily of Pope Benedict XVI, given in Parish Church of Castel Gandolfo, Monday, August 15, 2005.

"Social disorder, war, injustice and violence" can only be countered " by renewed appreciation and respect for the universal moral law [Sunday observance], that only by recognizing that law can the world have "dignity, life and freedom" with "conditions of justice and peace" in all the communities of the world, and that the promotion and defence of this law is what "must govern relations between nations and peoples in the pursuit of the common good of the human family...within the international community."

Address of Pope Benedict XVI to H.E. Mr Francis Rooney, New Ambassador of the United States of America to the Holy See, Saturday, November 12, 2005.

Sunday is a day of rest for all workers.

Address of Pope Benedict XVI to the Italian Christian Workers' Associations (A.C.L.I.), Clementine Hall, Friday, January 27, 2006.

People cannot be sanctified except on Sunday, that Christ transferred Sabbath sacredness to Sunday, that only those who keep Sunday belong to Christ, that only on Sunday does "the risen Lord make himself present among his followers", that only these "worship God properly", and that may Sunday "regain all its importance."

Letter of Pope Benedict XVI to Card. Francis Arinze on the Occasion of the Study Day in Honour of the 43rd Anniversary of the Promulgation of the Constitution on the Sacred Liturgy, Sacrosanctum Concilium, From the Vatican, November 27, 2006.

Sunday is an "obligation for all the faithful" which brings "authentic freedom enabling them to live each day", that it is the Lord's day, that it is "a day to be sanctified", and those who do not keep it suffer "the loss of an authentic sense of Christian freedom" and the loss of being "the children of God", that Sunday is the "primordial holy day" and "is meant to be kept holy", "a day of rest from work", which hopefully "will also be recognized by civil society" by law.

Sacramentum Caritatis: Post-Synodal Apostolic Exhortation on the Eucharist as the Source and Summit of the Church's Life and Mission, Given by Pope Benedict XVI in Rome, at Saint Peter's, February 22, 2007, the Feast of the Chair of Peter.

"It is necessary" "to hold Sunday in special high regard" in order "to remain united to Christ", as "it is the day dedicated to the Lord."

Message of Pope Benedict XVI to the Participants in the 9th International Youth Forum (Rocca di Papa, 28-31 March 2007), from the Vatican, March 28, 2007.

Only on Sunday can we experience "a personal encounter with Christ."

Apostolic Journey of Pope Benedict XVI to Brazil on the Occasion of the Fifth General Conference of the Bishops of Latin America and the Carribbean, Inaugural Session, Address of Pope Benedict XVI, Conference Hall, Shrine of Aparecida, Sunday, May 13, 2007.

"Without the Lord's day, we cannot live", that meeting with the Lord only occurs on the "specific day" of Sunday, that life does not flourish without Sunday, and that Sunday is a day of rest, of freedom and equality for the entire world.

Eucharistic Celebration Homily of Pope Benedict XVI , Saint Stephen's Cathedral, Vienna, Sunday, September 9, 2007.

Encouraged America to exercise “its leadership within the international community” based on “the common moral law [Sunday holiness].”

Address of Pope Benedict XVI to H.E. Mrs. Mary Ann Glendon, New Ambassador of the United States of America to the Holy See, Friday, February 29, 2008.

The world has greater need of hope for peace, justice and freedom, which “can never be delivered without obedience to the law of God [Sunday holiness]”.

Video-Message of the Pope Benedict XVI to Catholics and People of the United States of America on the Occasion of the Upcoming Apostolic Journey, April 15-21, 2008.

The RCC “makes its contribution (in the ethical and moral sphere) according to the dispositions of international law, helps to define that law, and makes appeal to it”, that we live in a time when little groups of independent people threaten the unity of the world, and that the only way to combat this problem is by establishing law and then ordering all of society according to this law, thus promoting “peace and good will throughout the earth.”

Apostolic Journey to the United States of America and Visit to the United Nations Organization Headquarters, Meeting with the Members of the General Assembly of the United Nations Organization, Address of Pope Benedict XVI, New York, Friday, April 18, 2008.

“In respecting religious liberty and the common good of all, Christians [in the USA and elsewhere] should seek recognition of Sundays and the Church’s holy days as legal holidays.”

Catechism of the Catholic Church, popular and definitive edition, 2000, par. 2188

"This organization proposes in every possible way to aid in preserving Sunday as a civil institution. Our national security requires the active support of all good citizens in the maintenance of our American Sabbath. Sunday laws must be enforced."

Quoted as "principles contained in the Constitution" of the original organization (then called the American Sabbath Union), cited in The Lord's Day Alliance, Twenty fifth Report (1913), p6.

In the fourth and fifth centuries, Sunday shows and Sunday theatres, it was complained, hindered the "devotion of the faithful," because many of the members attended them in preference to the church services. The church, therefore, demanded that the state interfere, and promote Sunday observance by law. "In this way, “Says Neander "the church received help from the state for the furtherance of her ends." This union of church and state served to establish the Papacy in power. A simular course pursued now will produce the same results.

AUGUSTUS NEANDER, General History of the Christian Religion and the Church, Torey translation (3rd American ed.), vol. 2, pp. 300,301

On September 7, 1947, Pope Pius XII declared that "the time for reflection and planning is past in religious and moral fields and the time for action has arrived." He said that "the battle in religious and moral fields hinged on five points: Religious culture, **the sanctifying of Sunday**, the saving of the Christian family, social justice and loyalty and truthfulness in dealings."

Evening Star (Washington D.C.), Sept. 8, 1947.

Sabbath, Change of, Lutheran Confession on:

Besides these things, there is a controversy whether Bishops or Pastors have power to institute ceremonies in the Church, and to make laws concerning meats, and holidays, and degrees, or orders of ministers, etc. They that ascribe this power to Bishops allege this testimony for it: 'I have yet many things to say unto you, but you cannot bear them now; but when that Spirit of truth shall come, he shall teach you all truth' (John 16: 12-13). They allege also the examples of the Apostles, who commanded to abstain from blood, and that which was strangled (Acts 15: 29). They allege the change of the Sabbath into the Lord's Day, contrary, as it seemeth, to the Decalogue; and they have no example more in their mouths than the change of the Sabbath. They claim the Church's power to be very great, because it hath dispensed with a precept of the Decalogue.

But of this question ours do thus teach: that the Bishops have no power to ordain anything contrary to the Gospel, as was showed before.

*Source: **The Augsburg Confession (1530), part 2, art. 7**, "Of Ecclesiastical Power," trans. in Philip Schaff, The Creeds of Christendom (New York: Harper, 1919), Vol. 3, pp. 63, 64.*

Have Sunday laws happened in the past? And WHAT became of those that broke them?

"Every man and woman shall repair in the morning to the divine service and sermons preached upon the Sabbath (Sunday), and in the afternoon to divine service, and catechizing, upon pain for the first fault to lose their provision and the allowance for the whole week following; for the second, to lose the said allowance and also be whipped; and for the third to suffer death."!!!

Laws, and Orders, Divine, Politique, & Martial For the Colony in Virginia: first established by Sir Thomas Gates, Knight, Lieutenant - General, the 24th of May, 1610

"The famous Jesuit, Francais Xavier, called for the Inquisition, which was set up in Goa, India, in 560, to check the 'Jewish wickedness' (Sabbath-keeping)."

Source: Adney, The Greek and Eastern Churches p 527,528.

"Aiphonse, king of Aragon, etc., to all archbishops, bishops, and to all others...We command you that heretics, to wit, the Waldeneses and Insabbathi (those who keep the Sabbath), should be expelled away from the face of God and from all Catholics and ordered to depart from our kingdom."

Source: Marianae Praefatio in Lucam Tudensem and quoted in Macima Bibliotheca Veterum Patrum Vol 25 p 190

Justin Martyr, a popular "mainstream Christian "of the second century (around 150 AD) believed that the Sabbath was an out-dated mosaic law which God placed on the Jews as “a mark to single them out for punishment they so well deserve for their infidelities."

Source: Justin Martyr, Dialogue with Trypho.

Canons against Sabbath-keepers from the French Council Toulouse in 1229: "Canon 3.- The lords of the different districts shall have the villas, houses, and woods diligently searched, and the hiding-places of the heretics destroyed. Canon 14. - Lay members are not allowed to possess the books of either the Old or the New Testaments."

Source: *Hefele. 5, 981, 962.*

Council, Moscow, 1503 : "The accused (Sabbath-keepers) were summoned; they openly acknowledged the new faith, and defended the same. The most prominent of them,...were condemned to death, and burned publicly in cages, at Moscow, Dec 17.1503.”

Source: H. Sternberfi, Geschichte der Juden

"This zeal for Saturday-keeping continued for a long time: even little things which might strengthen the practice of keeping Saturday were punished."

source: Bishop Anjou, Svenska Kirkans Historia after Motet i Upsala.

Pope Gregory I, 590-604 AD, Epistles b. 13:1- "Gregory, bishop by the grace of God to his well-beloved sons, the Roman citizens: It has come to me that certain men of perverse spirit have disseminated among you things depraved and opposed to the holy faith, so that they forbid anything to be done on the day of the Sabbath. What shall I call them except preachers of anti-Christ."

"Moreover, this same Pope Gregory had issued an official pronouncement against a section of the city of Rome itself because the Christian believers there rested and worshipped on the Sabbath."

Source: Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers.

"Some have suffered torture because they would not rest when others kept Sunday, for they declared it to be the holiday and law of Antichrist."

Source: Sebastian Frank, AD 1536. By this time in history the Seventh day Sabbath was severely under attack.

In Ethiopia, 1604 AD, the Jesuits influenced King Zadenghel to propose to submit to the Papacy " Prohibiting all his subjects, upon severe penalties, to not observe Saturday any longer."

Source: Gedde's Church History of Eithiopia p 311 and also in Gibbon's Decline and Fall chapter 47.

Catholic Provincial Council at Bergen -" We are informed that some people in different districts of the kingdom, have adopted and observed Saturday-keeping. It is severely forbidden- in holy church canon- one and all to observe days excepting those which the holy Pope, archbishop, or the bishops command. Saturday-keeping must under no circumstances be permitted hereafter further than the church canon commands. Therefore, we counsel all the friends of God throughout all of Norway who want to be obedient towards the holy church to let this evil of Saturday-keeping alone; and the rest we forbid under penalty of severe church punishment to keep Saturday holy."

Source: Dip, Norveg, 7, 397.

"The inquisitors...(declare) that the **sign** of a Vaudois (Waldeneses of France, Sabbath keepers) deemed worthy of death, was that he followed Christ and sought to obey the commandments of God."

Source: History of the Inquisition of the Middle Ages, H.C. Lea, Vol 1.